AUSTIN ZEPEDA

Aurora, IL
github.com/austinzep

EDUCATION

M.S. Civic Analytics

University of Illinois at Chicago

Graduated May 2026

Chicago, IL

B.A. Political Science

Minors in Business Administration and Music

Carthage College

Graduated May 2023

Kenosha, WI

Yorkville High School

Graduated May 2019

Yorkville, IL

SKILLS

- R programming and beginner Python.
- Public data expertise, policy analysis and program evaluation.
- Data collection, cleaning/processing, analysis, and visualization.
- Basic knowledge of SQL and no-SQL databases.
- Knowledge of the data life cycle.
- Cross-functional communication.
- Timeliness and consistency.
- Aptitude for learning, engaging processes, and identifying KPIs.
- Bilingual, proficient in English and Spanish.
- Microsoft Office, including intermediate Excel and beginner Access.
- Attentive, poised, self-starting and motivated.

OBJECTIVE

Public service professional seeking growth opportunities through a curiosity and passion for civic technology, data storytelling, and modernizing public data governance.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Administrative Aide

City of Aurora, IL

Dec 2023 - current Aurora, IL

- Supported the Chief Equity and Engagement Officer by coordinating initiatives that increased employee engagement.
- Led the Community Engagement Division through the NLC Community Engagement Academy—a technical assistance cohort of six cities nationwide.
- Championed a data-driven culture and information-sharing across departments for staff engagement events, grant activities, and projects delegated by the Mayor's Office.
- Organized 100+ cultural and community engagement events, driving civic participation and city equity initiatives.
- Oversaw department payroll—immediately automated timekeeping practices to slash processing time and led the department's integration of UKG time solutions.
- Created check requests, purchase orders, and sought grant opportunities.
- Managed departmental budget and reduced uncategorized expenditures by 90% YOY.
- Coordinated office operations for a team of 14—streamlining scheduling, managing employee records, and optimizing supply procurement.

Revenue Agent LTE

Wisconsin Department of Revenue

Jan 2023 - Feb 2023 Kenosha, WI

- 80% of time engaged in customer service calls related to business tax concerns.
- 20% of time filed individual Homestead Credits. Became familiar with internal database and taxpayer online accounts, WINPAS and MyTaxAccount.
- Collaborated with a team of Revenue Agents to enhance customer satisfaction, serving 50+ clients daily at the front desk.
- Enhanced the protection of PII for Wisconsin residents by implementing 2FA in all customer interactions.

Sales Associate - Interim Manager

The UPS Store

Jan 2020 - Sept 2021 Nashville, TN & Yorkville, IL

- Fulfilling customer orders, answering phones.
- Providing customer-centered service in a retail environment. Processed UPS insurance claims with a 100% success rate.
- Skilled in international and domestic shipping procedures.
- Shipping packages, processing mail.
- Managing personnel and operations not limited to: payroll, scheduling, billing mailbox customers and other accounts, regular royalty reporting.

ACTIVITIES

- Notary Public in State of IL.
- Mental Health First Aid certified
- Carthage Chorale
- Carthage College Student Government
- Belmont Office of Leadership Development (BOLD) program
- East Aurora Sports Boosters

Student Worker

Belmont School of Occupational Therapy

Aug 2019 - Apr 2020 Nashville, TN

- Performing office tasks such as taking phone calls, maintaining inventory of supplies, filing paperwork, and responding to the needs of faculty.
- Data entry for student fieldwork using Microsoft Office.

Supervisor

Simply Destinee

May 2019 - Jul 2019 Aurora, IL

- Performing supervisory responsibilities of dance camp staff, students, and the facility such as taking attendance, arranging transportation, managing the summer program.
- Curated a weekly report.

PROJECTS

Lemont Township Transportation Analysis

University of Illinois at Chicago

January 2026 - May 2026

- Analyzed administrative data from Lemont Township's senior and disability paratransit services, offered in partnership with Pace.
- Conducted interviews with peer municipalities (New Lenox, Orland Park, Lockport) for benchmarking and best practices
- Provided a recommendation to the Director of Transportation on whether to continue Pace partnership or to procure the municipality's own fleet and move operations in-house.

Capstone Thesis

Carthage College

Sept 2022 - Dec 2022

- A descriptive essay on political polarization and its consequences for social science research. It explores facets of data collection, data quality, and inferences/theory building.